

3D Printers

The 3D Printer is one of the greatest inventions of the 21st century allowing you to turn your ideas into real objects.

The latest Bond movie, Skyfall used a 3D printer from a German company called Voxeljet to produce three 1:3 scaled models of 007's Aston Martin just to blow up during the movie!

What sounds like a really cool toy to have is actually used for some very serious operations. Let's first understand how it works.



3D printing is achieved using an additive process in which successive layers of materials are laid out in different shapes. Cutting and drilling (also known as subtractive processes) are not involved at all making the process easy, efficient and highly suitable for prototyping.

The biggest consumer of the 3D Printer is the medical industry. So far it has produced prosthetics and bones and the ability to generate human organs from these machines is currently being tried out. If this is managed, it could revolutionize medicine and completely obliterate the need for organ donation. Using a 3D printer in conjunction with CAT scans, surgeons can print out tumours so that they know exactly what they're dealing with.

We're sure you're familiar with Pirate Bay, the file sharing company. It has launched a new content category called 'Physibles' i.e. data objects that can be made into physical products. 3D blueprints are uploaded and shared with those who want to print out the actual objects.